

Amendment No. 1 to HB2446

Crawford
Signature of Sponsor

AMEND Senate Bill No. 2338*

House Bill No. 2446

by deleting all language after the enacting clause and substituting:

SECTION 1. Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 68, Chapter 102, Part 1, is amended by adding the following as a new section:

68-102-155.

(a) The volunteer firefighter vehicle grant program is established to annually provide grants to select volunteer fire departments to assist with local match for federal grants to purchase vehicles. The commissioner of commerce and insurance shall establish, either by rule or delegated grant authority, the amount the state will contribute, but in no year is the grant program to fund the total local match portion.

(b) The commissioner of commerce and insurance shall endeavor to distribute this funding proportionally based on the number of recognized volunteer fire departments serving each of the three (3) grand divisions of this state.

(c) It is the legislative intent to fund the grant program created by subsection (a) by providing a sum-sufficient appropriation in each fiscal year's annual appropriation bill.

(d) The commissioner of commerce and insurance shall promulgate rules in accordance with the Uniform Administrative Procedures Act, compiled in title 4, chapter 5, to establish guidelines for evaluating grant requests and determining which volunteer fire departments will receive grants pursuant to this section.

(e) The commissioner of commerce and insurance shall decide which grants to award and shall disburse the grants to the selected volunteer fire departments. The commissioner shall endeavor to expend all funds appropriated to the grant program

each year, and any funds remaining may be expended for the volunteer firefighter equipment and training grant program under § 68-102-154. Any funds remaining must not revert to the general fund but remain available for expenditure in subsequent fiscal years for either grant program.

SECTION 2. For purposes of promulgating rules, this act takes effect upon becoming a law, the public welfare requiring it. For all other purposes, this act takes effect July 1, 2026, the public welfare requiring it.